

Rob Higgins

Staff Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Tech lead and fullstack engineer with 10+ years building production platforms at scale. Deep backend and frontend experience. Owned IAM and access systems, ad serving and audience tooling, and cross-cloud event-driven services. Tech lead for Snap's AR Enterprise Web SDK after the Vertebrae acquisition; most recently Head of Engineering at Panorama AI.

EXPERIENCE

Panorama AI · Dec 2023 – Feb 2026 · Santa Monica, CA

Head of Engineering · Oct 2024 – Feb 2026

- Managed data and platform teams behind LLM/ML products: Python services, PostgreSQL, event ingestion, and model inputs.
- Inherited and operated the company's IAM system; drove platform architecture, standards, and cross-team delivery.

Lead Software Engineer · Dec 2023 – Oct 2024

- Built predictive recommendation and audience tooling for email and social campaigns; delivered social look-alike capabilities and a React widget for Ashley Homestore (CA).

Snap Inc. · Jul 2021 – Sep 2023 · Santa Monica, CA

Software Engineer · AR Enterprise Web SDK Tech Lead

- Tech lead for the AR Enterprise Web SDK team after Snap acquired Vertebrae; led design through adoption across partners.
- Built a cross-cloud pub/sub layer with gRPC service APIs; shipped the ARES Web SDK (APIs, merchant integrations, event tracking).

Vertebrae Inc. · Feb 2016 – Jul 2021 · Santa Monica, CA + Remote

Senior Fullstack Software Engineer

- Early engineer; built the e-commerce platform through the Snap acquisition, including merchant SDK and enterprise integrations.
- Designed and built IAM / access-control for merchants and internal tools; owned ad serving, predictive audience lists, and look-alike social campaigns.
- Owned cloud infrastructure with Terraform, scaling to millions of users with Docker, serverless, and microservices; event ingestion into PostgreSQL.

SKILLS

Python · TypeScript / JavaScript · gRPC · Distributed Systems · Event-Driven Architecture · PostgreSQL · IAM / Access Control · Platform Engineering · Ads / Audience Tooling · React / Node.js · REST APIs · AWS / GCP · Terraform · Docker / Kubernetes · Microservices · Data Pipelines / ETL · Technical Leadership · System Design

EDUCATION

Full Sail University

AAS, Recording Arts Technology